

Anonymous Collection Of An Open Hour

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Editor's Note:

This collection catalogs a simple experiment that anyone can do. What happens when you open your door every day for one hour (over the course of one month) and invite anyone with interest to come and put pen to paper under the filter of a common prompt?

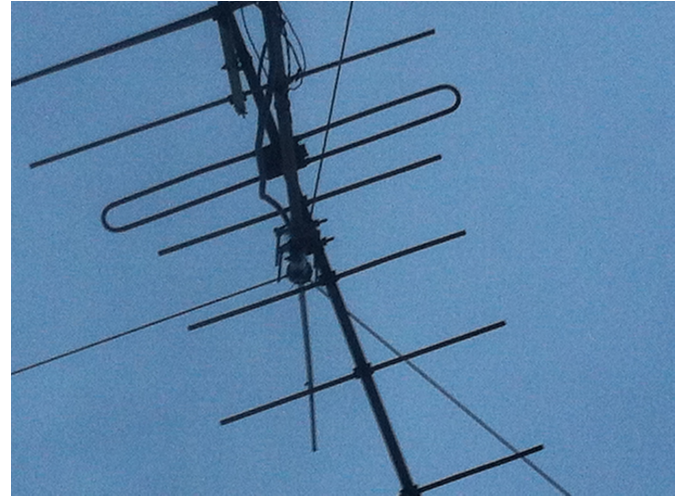
You never know who will show up or what they will bring or what they will leave behind. Playing both guest and host, you take these things as they come, unconditionally. The openness of possibility is in and of itself the goal. The perhaps rather more utopic means and end can be described as sharing a disciplined yet creative and solitary state in a spontaneous community setting.

The resulting "product" is journal, fantasy, poetry, prose, report, and is accompanied by questions about when we care what occurs in our own heads and the heads of others, when we think we understand it, how we welcome in/differentiate or fail to differentiate between the sacred, profane and mundane: the thoughts, dreams and things of daily life.

The willingness to utter and question so is generated in the investment to encounter a kind of style or persistence of initiative where radicality, sophistication and naiveté not only intersect but presume to gleefully intertwine. Sometimes failure is more interesting than success.

Here the gesture of anonymity is positioned as posthuman-romantic-strategic as well as vulnerable-dubious. On the one hand we are exhausted with our names, faces, bodies and all that by and with which we are identified. Looking ahead with a monist eye, we imagine critique without judgment, that maybe you could be a free thing. On the other hand, witness our doubts, the relentlessness of our egos, of dreams, of nostalgia, even of our sometimes unabashed sentimentality. We might be ready to be anyone, but not yet no one. In a room, hidden from view, naked, at Babel, waiting in line at the supermarket, all alone, with friends and lovers, disagreeing about style, correctness and the relevancy of topics, inspired, curious, bored and being boring, a gang of voices becomes the only voice.

I can recommend this volume to you, whoever you are, in the way I recommend walking down the street or through a field. I am grateful to anyone who ever came and ever took something and ever left something behind.



1

A Rope in the Palm of Their Hand¹

This has to do with the contrast between restraining yourself to a time and space and set of tools and issuing effortlessness.

This has to do with the tension, like everything else.

My mother always used to say that freedom is obedience. Obedience to what?

Obedience to breath.

What good comes of refusing fuel, from avoiding stimulation, from delaying release? It should seem contrary to create blocks, but maybe there are worse ideas.

The thing you are holding is also holding you. But how?

Some consider a glass of water punishment. You can hear their laughter now.

Once there was a fountain. Once there was a washing machine. Once there was a spin cycle. Once there was a kitchen sink. Once there was your disappointment. Once there was the flushing of toilets.

The thing you are holding is also holding you. But how?

2

Rope in the palm of their hand²

Franziska was the name of the boat. Probably named after one of the King's mistresses, but this is just a rumour. I was 12 when I first set foot on it. I remember it was all shiny and it smelled like freshly painted wood. My first voyage lasted two weeks. We sailed along the shore until the coast of Spain. The third night there was a storm. Waves as tall as a horse were hitting the boat. The crew started running in all directions. I pulled the ropes. The rope was soaked, yet dry. It was a young rope. Freshly out of the rope factory, its surface hadn't been tamed yet by hundreds of hands going over it thousands of times. No. It was still new and rugged, with threads coming out of it tearing up the outer layers of my palm. My palm was young and soft as well, untamed by the years of pulling hundreds of ropes in thousands of stormy nights. My hand would, in time, get used to the harshness of the rope, and acquire some of its roughness. The rope would, in time, get used to the softness of my skin, the delicacy of my hands, and borrow a bit of its gentleness. In time, the rope and my hand would become friends. But then, on that first, unexpected and brutal encounter, my palm lost the battle with the rope.

3

Rob' s Word Shop³

I would like to sell you lemonade at 10 cents a cup. I wish I could tell you it is made from real lemons. It is made from real lemons. At any rate I spent all morning making the sign. It says "LEMONADE 10 cents." We set up on the corner to catch all the traffic of the main street. The saddest thing that has happened to me is when, while I was setting up, I went inside to get more cups and, when returning, found a small boy happily drinking a cup of lemonade. I indignantly exclaimed that the lemonade cost 10 cents, tore the cup from his hand, and emptied its contents on the sidewalk. I watched his smile crumble into a million pieces and big tears well up in his eyes. He pointed to the money jar, which to my horror, contained one lonely little dime, and ran away.

One little dime.

What could I sell you now for one little dime ?

This is a path that leads to the desert. When the light is right you take out your brush. In between the shops that make a row on a lower ledge at the base of the mountain you will find gaps of white space that have been left, no pigment or texture. I've always assumed this was just a result of painting from abroad with a wide brush. I can give you two words. It's up to you to do what you want with them. The words are "acclimatization" and "dynamite."

4

A Conversation Between James and Jane, Part 1⁴

While they were waiting for the subway, she was hoping to never come. She knew that after leaving him, they would not see each other for long. Sometimes Jane put excuses to not telling him. But at the same time she also thought "He is going to realize it." Meanwhile, James was thinking: "This subway is delaying a lot, how long it takes." In addition there was an annoying noisy cat meowing.

It seemed there was a delay on the subway. Because of this Jane was happy because it gives her some time to encourage her. But James was impatient. At one point, Jane thought she heard the horn from the subway. He thought thanks God! It's coming. She was very nervous. She said to herself, "is now or never". If we see each other again, that will be at least within two years. He can meet someone, fall in love, moving in together. He has to know.

He was relieved he will not have to hide any more. She would have time to be distracted, meet other people and when she return, she would be thinking about other things and not so steep there. She would left him alone to discover himself.

Finally, Jane perked up and said to James.

Jane: James, I have to tell you something.

James: What?

Jane: It will disturb you what I'll say.

James: What happened?

Jane: There's something I want to say you for a long time, but I didn't dare.

Now that we will not see each other for two years, you better know.

James was getting nervous, bothered by suspense. He said nothing suspicious despite he was anxious and worried. He thought, "If I show her it bothers me takes her so long to tell me, she won't tell me, It's better if I keep silent and not interrupt her".

Jane: James, I had to sell the house.

When she told him, the metro was coming.

James replied: You left me with nothing. You told Mom?

Jane: I have to go. I had to sell it, to pay this trip, it is very expensive.

Jane took advantage of the trouble and took the subway. James struggled to explain why he did not think he also needed the money. He failed. Jane left.

James thought: "What a bitch!, she went away with my money! So hopefully I kill her when she came back! If I would have worried more about her... I cared only of myself happily that I will not see my sister for a while.

Tormented thinking, if I had been more attentive to her I would have realized she has cheated me. When Jane was gone and the subway disappeared, the cat stopped meowing.

5

A conversation between Jane and James, part 1⁵

Jane and James are having a conversation. No, they're having an argument. No, they're having a fight. Somebody should call the ambulance. Or the police. Or the firefighters. Jane and James are looking at each other enraged. Smoke comes from their noses and ears. Jane and James are burning with rage. The fire alarm in the building starts (what is the right phrasal verb for this?). The smoke fills the corridors of the building and gets to the other floors. The neighbours are alarmed. The neighbours are frightened and panicked. It is 1 am and they think the building is on fire. The neighbours get out of bed in their pyjamas and start evacuating the building. They take the stairs, as the elevator is unsafe and not recommended in case of fire. One of them has his laptop in his arms, the most important possession. A young girl took her cat. Then there is the couple in their underwear and with a towel around their body. The kid on the third floor has asthma and he cannot breathe. From outside the building, everyone is trying to understand where the fire is. There is smoke coming out of every window, but there doesn't seem to be any fire. And no heat either. The woman on the 2nd floor called the firefighters. Three trucks come in a hurry. The firefighters enter the building wearing masks and equipment resistant to high temperatures. They can't understand where the smoke comes from. Under Jane and James's door one of them can see a thread of light. The firefighters smash the door open. Jane and James are in the living room, having a conversation. The light is on. Smoke is coming out of their nostrils and ears and the pores of their respective skins. Jane and James continue to speak to each other, oblivious of the forty-five firefighters that have just invaded their apartment. The firefighters align in a row, pull the hose and splash Jane and James with water from head to toes, thus stopping the conversation. The air begins to clear.

6

A conversation between Jane and James Part 1⁶

James the kettle is boiling. James can you please pass the bread? Jane, I found your favorite dress in the trunk of the Honda. Weren't you looking for it last week? Yes my sister came for lunch and I was in the mood for something yellow. James, can you get the telephone? I'm not sure where it is. The volume's a bit loud Jane. I'm in a meeting, do you mind? Oh of course not, I'm sorry, here let me close the door. Jane what can you tell me about oregano? How do you like to use it? Jane I've decided to cut sugar from my diet. I support you in this, James. There's a film about the love between a dumpster and its contents playing at the cinema tonight. Do you want to go? What language is it in? I think it's American English. James sometimes I have the feeling that you are a ghost. Jane, I am a ghost. James, why are you crying? Is there anything I can do? Can you draw a bath? Jane, what do you want to eat for dinner? Well you know James, what about that new little place down the street? What kind of food is it? It's a fusion restaurant. And they host DJs who play electronic music. James, I want you to promise me that you will never cut yourself again. Jane, I cannot do that. I know. Jane, I wish we were cats. James, I wish we were fish. Jane, I change my mind I would prefer to be a rock. Hand me the gallon of milk, will you? Jane, why do people run away from me – what are they scared of? James your face is glowing. Jane do you want to have children? No James, do you? Yes, but I don't know how. It's easy. No it's not. Jane are you a woman or a man? James, you're funny. Jane I'm falling asleep will you please wake me up? James we have nothing to lose. Jane, you are right. We have nothing to lose. Jane how will I recognize you on the other side? James, you have something stuck between your teeth. Jane, I got this for you. Do you like it? James, I'm bleeding. Jane, my nose is running, have you got a tissue. Jane can you tell me what time it is? Jane can you give me a hand lifting this?

7

Five Meanings Of

Five meanings of Cadillac that you didn't know include nail polish (in that leather bag), the second of eleven names of a show poodle from the house of Dynasty Titillation, a mint ice cream sandwich available at Gary's Diner on the corner of Jackson and Dawson streets in Madison, Wisconsin, a pale pink rose with no scent, and a sexual pose accomplished by three persons possessing a penis.

The first time a meaning fails
And the sad room is rejoice
Is a grieve. Is some
dodger thing
Is some thing better than you
Another meaning but which one do you
mean. Do you mean anyone?
Did you meet anyone?
Sliver and shiver up when you will
It's a real thrill if you know the meaning
There's never one there's one
I want to meet the meaning on your face
Mean It, do you, and five
places, five beers, five months,
five lovers, five colors, five smells,
five minutes, five fingers, five
boredoms, five classic poses.

Five meanings of "OK". You want to be alone. You don't like the food.
You're ready to have some fun. You don't know what to think or say.
Maybe it's time to change the subject.

Think about five things you want but cannot have. That is good.

8

Made in china

Lo chino es de mala calidad y no dura, si vas a comprar algo que sea japonés. Esos si saben de calidad, de diseño. ¿Has visto? tienen una sutileza en el diseño alucinante, la manera como ven al usuario, la naturalidad de las cosas, como lo hacen simple. No buscan adaptarse a un usuario, no se rebusca la forma. Si la forma ya está, si el material te dice como quiere ser tratado. ¿Por qué hacer de eso otra cosa? Es saber escuchar, saber entender. ¿Sera que los chinos no tienen buena capacidad auditiva, no tienen la sensibilidad para entender lo que el material quiere ser? Está Claro que el metal quiere ser algo fuerte, imponente, duradero, inquebrantable. ¿Nos estaremos equivocando? ¿Será que él quisiera ser otra cosa? algo suave, blanco, cálido.

9

Rob's Wordshop⁷

Conceptual writing. I have to google that. Today's text was a short essay about Rob's Wordshop. A writer who refused to write, so he sold words to customers. Their own words, transcribed at a profit. There is just so much to say about this.

Selling words, letters. What's the point though, words should be free, right?

I'd like to be able to buy words. I get them for free now, but as the walking vendors in the Mexico City underground say, cinco pesos vale, cinco pesos cuesta. It's worth 5 pesos, it costs 5 pesos. Extending the logic, words don't cost anything because they aren't worth anything. What if dictionaries came with prices for every word? What if you weren't allowed to use a word unless you paid for it? It's starting to be like that in branding. In Luxembourg, Apple sued a newly opened restaurant because it was called "An apple a day". There was one word that was not allowed to be used. Apple won the litigation.

How would they determine the price of words? What would be the demand-and-supply graph for this? Would words that are often used be cheaper because there is so much supply? Or more expensive because there is so much demand? Would rare, unusual words for which there is no demand be cheaper? Or would they cost a lot more because they are luxury words, premium, only to be used by a select group of customers – the writers? Like those specialist books published by a University Press, that cost so much, because their readership is so little?

I'd like to be able to buy words when I'm out of inspiration.

Actually, words are not free unless they are in your mother tongue. To buy words in other languages you have to pay a quite substantial fee, at times.

The funny thing is that you don't pay these fees to the word owners, only to some nameless intermediaries.

If I invent a word, would I be able to patent it, in order to gain financial benefits from its use?

The writer who refused to write is like the musician who refuses to make music and only plays cover versions of popular songs. It's not that unusual, actually. Like painters who only copied the great masters.

Why would one pay to receive his own words, though?

Maybe he was not a writer who refused to write, but a painter in love with letters. Calligraphy is not about the meaning of the word, but about its form and shape, it's like looking at a photo and treating it as an abstract image, seeing not the people or the objects, or the nature, but the shapes and colours. If you look at a photo as an abstract, you can turn it upside down or flip it 90 degrees to the right or through the left, it will not lose its communicative value. But if you flip it, our brains are so dependent on making sense of everything, that they will turn 90 degrees as well, and will register the thing as, for example, "a portrait of the artist flipped horizontally", instead of "a yellowish shape in the right half of the image".

Maybe this is what Rob also wanted to convey about words, and he was misinterpreted, – that they have an aesthetic value in addition to their conceptual value. That sometimes we should look at words without trying to understand them, only noting how the curved lines flow and intertwine, how they curl and bend. To look at our own words as if we were looking at Georgian script, indulging in the pleasure of simply seeing, without understanding.

Branding is actually where the shape of the letter adds to the communicative value of the word.

But we value content over form, we are taught to disregard the visual part, the word's outer skin and dive directly into its meaning, and maybe it shouldn't be like that.

It makes me think of the differences between non-tonal languages and tonal languages. In non-tonal languages, the primary meaning is derived from what sounds you pronounce. In tonal languages, meaning is communicated through both the sounds and how you say them, the pitch of the voice. Would it be possible to have a similar situation in writing?

Where the meaning of a word would differ if you wrote it beautifully or not, in cursive letters or not, in serif or sans serif, in italics or bold? Similar to the way the tone of your voice carries meaning in speaking in a tonal language, the “tone” of your hand would carry meaning in writing.

Poetry, classical poetry with rhythm and rhyme is another way of forcing manner into content. Ideas conveyed matter equally as their sound, the beauty of the spoken language, the prettiness to the ear. As calligraphy is prettiness to the eye.

A business similar to Rob’s Wordshop would be transcribing an idea into rhyme. Or maybe not. That still requires creativity, while Rob did not invent his own fonts.

10

Made in China

I haven’t met too many people who were “made in China.” Why should only objects be made in China? There are a zillion people “made in China” here in BA. Makes me think of Wong Kar Wai’s Happy Together somehow. Two Chinese come to BA. A gay Chinese couple actually. Or were they Taiwanese? Now they run all (ALL!) of the medium-sized supermarkets in the city. Made in China. I don’t know if I like that or not, if I like them or not. I wonder how would a salad made in China taste. Ingredients made in China. It sounds fake and cosmopolitan (the new 20th century cosmopolitan) and made of chemicals. Factory-produced lettuce and lab-produced onions and tomatoes. Olive oil that does not come from olives. Like that news from a few years ago that the Chinese were producing eggs artificially. Well, wood can now be produced artificially by a certain bacteria, why would eggs and lettuce be different?

I remember when I first saw the phrase “made in China”. It was before ‘89. I barely knew how to read. There were those tiny little red metal boxes, round shaped, with a brown cream inside. Made in China was all I could read. My mother would dip my fingers in that cream, so it would hurt when I would try to eat my nails or to pick my nose. I had no idea what China was back then.

I also had those Chinese toys. I distinctly remember a little accordion for kids, white and green, made of plastic but heavy, strong plastic, that resembled porcelain, not the cheap plastic toys today are made of. I would take it from the huge box full with toys and not know what to do with it after. I never learned how to play it. I’m not sure it could be played. Its sound was something between a gentle huff and that strong yell made by a donkey. It was not my first introduction to music.

Then that Chinese sort of board game. I don’t know how it was called. It came in a box of octagonal shape, with a picture of a pagoda on it. Inside, there was the board, the shape of a star with six corners (or were they five?) with small round holes connected by lines. And the little glass balls

of six colours (or five) that fit inside each hole. I think it was supposed to be a game played between six persons or fewer, but I never knew the rules of that game. We would gather with other kids in the block and just invent our own game. At times we wouldn't even invent any rules, we would ditch the board and simply play with the glass balls instead. They were white, yellow, black, red, green, blue. Ok, six. As I was an only child, I would often play the board game on my own. I would play with two teams, on behalf of both teams, pretending I didn't know the moves of the other. Well, I didn't have a strategy in fact. It was just random moves. In the end there would be a winner. Or maybe not, I don't remember that clearly, I was never focused on winning, and I still am not. Sometimes I would just take a few balls, give them names, assign them roles and invent conversations between them. Like I did with my pens and stationery objects.

Those were also made in China, if I come to think of it. I remember the pens that had a reservoir for ink. The reservoir was not replaceable, the ink would come in little bottles and the pens had a system to "suck" it in. Accidents would happen. Ink would spread and stain my hands, my clothes, the table, the notebook. I would have blotting paper at hand to quickly remediate.

The pencil cases were also "made in China". Metal pencil cases.

As I did not speak any English, I did not know what "made in" meant. I didn't even pronounce it correctly. I read it letter by letter.

I had no idea of globalization, world trade, sweatshops in Bangladesh, China's expansion or anything. "Made in China" carried no ethical connotations, it simply referred to some objects that came from far away. \

I remember Gertie. She was Chinese, she worked with me as a trainee when in Luxembourg. She had studied in Warwick and was very (Very!) ambitious. We could not dislike her though, she was quiet and calm and so hard-working that she put every one of us to a shame. Once she had booked a weekend trip to London. When Susan the senior manager asked her to cancel it, she did, without opposition. She lost all the money she had paid. I felt threatened by the fact that she was so non-rebellious and accepted all things that we wanted to change. Her China was cold, rainy, grey and polluted. Unlike the coloured China of my toys.

I remember Chinese tales. No fairies involved, but dragons and old men playing Go on the edge of a river. No tales of love conquests and he and she living happily ever after.

Somehow China never got to me.

11

MADE IN CHINA

Katya drove the busfull of boys through the bellies of mountains and finally, on the last fumes of engine fuel, coasted into the clearing that opened up in front of an enormous block cement building, a perfect gigantic cube with thin wide horizontal windows slitting its four sides.

The boys hesitatingly stepped out of the bus into the dense fog filling the clearing. The light of the province was always the same, controlled from a tower at the top of the Great Mountain. It was a combination of natural and artificial light.

When the last boy had timidly set foot on the soft neon green ground, becoming the end of a long single file, Katya took a position facing the line and explained that they had all been brought here to produce an important collection of paintings. They would receive detailed training and be paid wages they would be eligible to collect at the end of their two-year stay.

Ryu, the smallest of the boys but in fact one of the oldest, interrupted Katya's speech when he suddenly collapsed and was seen lying unconscious, his mouth slightly open, his left fingers curled to form a loose fist.

Where Ryu was when he opened his eyes, he could see the sky but was surrounded by four walls. Streams of cool air passed over his body. To his left the wall was filled with seashells, embedded in the cement. He turned his head to face this wall, studying each shell and heard the music of two flutes.

Then he heard the singing of voices:
"Red, for the whole side.
Dip the brush in water and green.
Palest blue in careful strokes
Palest gray in tiny dots

Three brushes down of brown
And the water white caps
Golden red hat and boat
Tiny waves silver gold..."

The voices continued but seemed to be travelling further and further in a distant direction. Ryu did not understand what the words were supposed to mean. Was it a bad translation? Were they singing about the paintings?

Finally Ryu had rolled over and was now facing the wall opposite the seashell wall. This wall was covered with framed paintings, each the size of a playing card, although the orientation of some was vertical whereas others horizontal and some were oval in shape. Ryu stood up from the table he was lying on and went to have a closer look at the paintings. The floor was much warmer against his bare feet than he had expected. With his nose now just several centimeters away from the wall, he stared at one of the paintings. On the left, a shack. In the middle a small boat. On the far right horizon a sun. He looked around at the other paintings and noticed that in every one of them there was a shack, a boat, and a sun. And the colors used were always the same. But what he felt when he looked at each of them was not the same. The temperature of the air varied. The sounds heard in the distance were various. Sometimes he could hear birds. Another time he could hear a mixture of running water and a horn. Sometimes footsteps. Sometimes when leaves fall into the water. Sometimes a motor. Sometimes a dog barking. Sometimes nothing. Sometimes just one voice humming quietly.

Ryu noticed his fingertips were numb and looked back to find the door leading down a long long flight of stairs into a large room where all of the other boys were busy rinsing out bowls and stacking them upside down in sets of four.

12

HONEST MANIPULATIONS

[Fifteen minutes asleep in a hammock with the sun on your face.

The sun went behind the clouds an estimated two minutes after you closed your eyes, and returned an estimated one minute before you opened them.

[Seven minutes asleep in a hammock with the sun on your face.

The sun was moderately to thinly veiled for the duration of this exercise. At no point did the sun fully hit your face.

It was an honest manipulation to steal seven bananas in the night and return them early in the morning before the king arose. The king needs seven bananas to stick in each of his orifices when he awakes. He has precisely seven of them.

It was an honest manipulation to add rabbit ears to the pin-the-tail-on-the-donkey. But you're a lousy cheat and you peaked through the blindfold in order to "win".

It was an honest manipulation to purposefully rip the ass of your trousers, however untasteful.

It was an honest manipulation to put on a coat when you were cold.

13

Frommage a la plage

Une hommage a la plage
C' est peut-être la fenêtre
Serieuse et mystérieuse
Trés froid, pas moi
Une crise; il est triste

Il n' y a q' une chance
a minuit
avec la mère
et quatre bouteilles de la nouvelle
Beaujolais
pour quoi?
Este-ce que la grand chance
la premiere chance?
Tu ne peux pas manger
Tu ne peux pas danser
Tu ne peux pas rien.
Mais ce n' est pas fini.

Alors, attention –
Combien de mals,
Combien de l' argent,
Combien de déjoulé
Puis tes couleures...

Tu arrangé la fête
Tu pleurait
ça suffit
c' etait mal c' etait bon.
mais très
mais très
mais très

14

A Conversation Between James and Jane, Part 2^a

Thomas and Gabriel have been friends for about 5 years. They got along very well from the beginning. They had much in common, and were such things in common which made them a few times from fighting. Both are fans of rock, both are very talented, both are very attractive. They are both passionate about many things in common. But the problem was that both of them enjoy calling much attention. With such brilliant personalities had to give some prominence. Without wishing to fight, Gabriel began to experience other kinds of music, to see if they could differentiate Thomas. But every time he tried it, he failed. People always said, you're very talented, but why not follow the duo with Thomas? They never saw him as a single, always connected him to Thomas. Why he couldn't be recognized by himself, without relating him to Thomas?

Thomas caught his attention that Gabriel got bored of music they did together. For him, the soul was a slow and sluggish music style, without energy. It was much better the music they played together. But he would not stop his artistic impulses. If he wanted to try new things, good for him. But it seemed that his recitals, increasingly fewer people came. Neither had success separately. But Gabriel increasingly fed up over not being recognized by his own talent.

Gabriel when he did not have much success as a single artist, and saw another musical style didn't inspire him a lot. Applause began to disappear. One day he called Thomas and wanted him as a guest artist in his recital. That caught Thomas's attention, he was offended of being considered as a guest. He rejected his proposal.

Thomas opened new albums alone, without Gabriel. Only by composing music he was already happy. Playing alive, it was just to get some money. Gabriel was increasingly disappearing. Until he lied to himself: "I got bored of the music."

But Thomas missed him. He missed when they drank wine together on winter nights, just sharing. He missed sharing moments of joy, art, and the only way he had to remember him, was playing his piano and composing.

15

A conversation between Jane and James

She was bending down to tie the shoelaces of faded black boots, looking downward as she spoke, "I don't think there's going to be time after rehearsal. Can you tell me now?" She continued looking downward, taking her time with the shoelaces. He was staring at her head saying nothing. Finally she stood up taking a big breath of air and account of his face, raising her eyebrows as she tossed back thick straight long silver hair. Several seconds passed before her stomach growled, after which she let out a long sigh. With a clear and defining short nod of the head, she gathered up her coat, scarf, and bag from the countertop, turned on her heels and made her way to the front door. "See you at rehearsal then!" She called back just before the door closed. He remained standing and blankly staring for a minute or two after she was gone. The way he felt was dull. Unable to retrace or recount how he got there or what might have happened in between, he became aware of himself washing dishes, smelling the combination of lemon-scented soap and beef broth. The smell of roast beef reminded him of the Sundays of his childhood. His mother was in the kitchen. His father and brothers were somewhere quietly in the background. He was lying on the floor facing the large windows, looking out at the tall eucalyptus trees, listening to Brahms.

The dishes were done. The sink and the countertops and the floor were sparkling. He only heard the faint humming buzz of the overhead light. Dusk had just passed, he realized. He decided to vacuum the floors. He created a pattern on the carpet as he vacuumed. The way he felt was ecstatic. After vacuuming, he rearranged the magazines on the coffee table, he dusted every surface. He lined up her shoes by the door in a neat row. After lining them up he decided he would polish them. After polishing all the shoes, he decided to clean the fridge, throwing out a rotting head of lettuce, three flacid and ill-looking carrots, and an open tin of dried-out cat food. He scrubbed and wiped down every surface with a vinegar-based all-purpose cleaner. All that remained in the refrigerator was half a bottle of

generic brand ketchup, a bottle of dill pickles, two six-packs of diet coke and an unmarked dime of expensive and offensive smelling cheese. Finally having re-located his sense of urgency, he went to pack his things. Everything fit into one bag. He carefully placed the keys on the countertop, memorizing how they looked there. He scanned the room, satisfied and calm. His bag in hand he closed the door behind him, heading towards the train station with a kick in his stride. He wondered what music they were singing at rehearsal at that very moment.

16

A conversation between Jane and James, part 2⁹

Jane wakes up to the sound of punk music coming from the loudspeakers. James is a morning person. Jane says "good morning." Jane goes to the kitchen to make breakfast. It would be great if breakfast were waiting for her already, but it's not the case. Jane prepares some scrambled eggs and asks James if he wants them with or without tomatoes. James doesn't answer. James is absorbed in his music. Jane eats and leaves some for James. Jane goes to the bathroom and prepares to have a shower. It will take a while, so she asks him if he will need the bathroom within the next hour. James is carefully browsing through his collection of CDs to select the next track to play. Jane tells him it's time he passed the vacuum cleaner. Jane asks him if he has any plans for tonight, as she's going out with some friends. James has passed to his vinyl collection. Lately all their conversations are like that. James stops the music and leaves the house. For the first time today, he speaks. He says "bye!"

17

A conversation between Jane and James Part 2¹⁰

Babe your atoms are slick, are you a homosexual? What is homosexual?
How many brooms in your kitchen, how many spoons? Cause I want to spank you with them. Break a nail and go to jail – I'll break you out babe – the night is young. You have the finest nucleus my head is whirling.
Neutron to the max are there any more beers? In the can? In the basement? In a bucket of melting ice? Hey I wanna marry you! They'll see us hopping across the horizon on pogo sticks, throwing rocks over the moons. Driving into fun houses. Never sleeping but with our mouths open. I'm gonna grow some flowers in there. I love you let's make a mess. You know what doesn't exist? Tomorrow. Gimme that. I'll show you how to use it. Smash a window and slam dunk that hoop in a yogurt shop with color sprinkles up your studded ripped jeans and smell of a goat. We'll do this until it gets old. We'll do this until we are old. Or we could just change our names, shave our heads, go see a doctor. Get over here and give me a kiss.

18

Stopping and freezing¹¹

A steady job.
Marriage for life.
The Chinese wall.
The written word.
Bad ideas.
Every update, every new iphone.
TV, MTV.
Reality shows.
Sub Zero wins.
A walk in the moon.
A stage in the flying process.
A dot.
A spot
All memories.
Off line.
Golf.
Gelly.
Derek Zoolander's "Blue Steel".
A bet.
An old forest.
Cigarettes.
Candy Crush.
Aerosmith, Foo fighters, Green Day, Divididos, etc.
Holidays.
Ketamine.
Steroids.
Telescopes.
Mirrors facing mirrors.
Footsteps.

19

Stopping and freezing¹²

A red sign parks
A tongue embarks and sticks
To the roof slipping
Time for an end
The frost preserves and
You deserve a medal. A cold one
To rub between your fingers like
A coin in the pocket of
Your parka, as you wait for the
Train. It's coming, you are going.
Feel me I'm freezing. I've always been freezing.
For sake please touch me.

The ecstasy of shatter is why you slow everything down – so that density
maxxes and rips out its seams. You begin so that you can finish, which is
not the same as stopping. Neither is it quitting.

Neither are baby buds in the field if they are forgotten in the snow,
not forgotten. Neither is poetry nor your time here.

Neither is sincerity, nor foolishness, nor gratitude nor romance. Of particle
physics, of the Lord, we are left with prayer. We stop, the same. We freeze,
the same.

20

Stopping and Freezing¹³

She crossed Antarctica by herself one summer. The crew came along until
the first base, gave her help, encouragement, advice. She knew she could
call them anytime she wanted, using that special radio device she was
carrying. But she promised to herself not to do it, unless she was in serious
danger. She advanced slowly on the blinding ice, hearing nothing but the
sound of her shoes on the ice. She advanced along the edges of the
mountain chain that crosses the continent. She had never experienced
such cold in her life. She was dragging along a sleigh with all her supplies,
her tent and all the communication and other equipment. The cold took
hold of her body's endings – her toes, her finger, her nose and ears, despite
the multiple layers of thick, thermal resistant fabric that were covering her
from head to toe. The cold took hold of her mind, directing all her thoughts
at survival, how to keep her body temperature, breathe, avoid unnecessary
effort. At times, she was unsure of where she was and whether she was
heading in the right direction, she was exhausted and wanted to return
back to the base, but

21

FOOL'S GOLD¹⁴

Mandy came and left. Behind a ring for thucking. That's bent for down I hear the boil and lift mine lips. Nothing to do with the devil till dawn wipes lemons on her shoulders. If the head is adorned in chains, or hair or precious fibers of another, she might see through it. Let's never forget our view. Or exchange it when the rider comes. The archway stands for protection, its leaves and southern sky in the north a promise. That we are not sure will be kept. I trust my grandmother's colors. It's her blouse you're wearing. Don't worry if there will be enough. Time will coffee its tea its incense its fog its dusty page. Pressed in feather fair the feminine air. Can it be a masculist wig? Does this teach you anything about desire? You must not eat these days. Playboy mansions await where you will not know them. I will teach you or you will teach me. Dive at sunrise where your famine swears. Not the same as impressive. That's what you can't touch. If you are, then a Buddhist. For example it has been said that tragicomedy is the deliberate return to naiveté after the ultimate complexity. The fashion is toxic, organic, synesthaesietic, emotional, but it is still misunderstood most of the time. That won't change that. If we remove the chains from her head does the bird fly or does the face fall off? If it's her only hair will logic break down or breathe runways to your ears? Meaning poses but doesn't show you her pussy. Urinating on the bathroom bus sealing the deal with Russia is Miss March, power broker and breaker of the hearth. If mother leaves she must come home. Still hope to close your eyes when let. Everyday teen, a growing world. In evening darkness, theater weaves. Plastic blood and impressive cologne and pornography affirms the world. Do you hear the corners I can't. The one deemed the possible impossible is the one I won't remember. Your meanness is fading. Wake up. Does the babies live in the trees, in your designs? Miranda came and left. Mahogany came and left. Marjorie is playing piano. Mick swims upriver. Multiply the description and they all will return.

22

Stopping and Freezing¹⁵

Para. Cancelado. No quiero hablar mas de eso.

Cuantas veces te lo dije. Por algo esta ahí, congelado.

No entendiste nada. Para. Te dije que pares. Ahora sigues? Como esta la situación?

Quiero cancelarlo. Quiero parar. Pero lo quiero dejar así. Capaz algún dia.

Te dije que no.

Basta

Para

Cancela

Congela

Te odio

No estaba todo bien? Yo pensé...

Para y no pienses

No entiendo

Te callas

Pero que paso?

La vida, tu , yo, la vida

Pero estaba bien?

No,no, no estaba bien

Pero parecía..

Parecía tantas cosas, tu parecías otro

Pero soy yo

No eres el que yo quería

El que querías?

Si, yo sabía lo que quería, casi llegas a ser.

No entiendo

No entiendes nada, nunca.

La verdad que estoy confundido.

Confúndete un poco mas. Pero para. Para que esto no da para mas.

Da para otras cosas

No entendiste. Nunca entendiste. No sabes quien soy yo.

Quien eres?

Ahora te lo preguntas?

Me acabas de decir

Para, es triste

Que es triste?

No entendiste nada

Algo creo que si

Hazme una lista

En que estamos, haciendo compras?

Una lista para congelar. Vemos si en 5 años soy eso que dijiste. Me gustaría verla ahora pero hagamos el experimento.

Entonces? Ahora paramos y nos vemos en 5 años

Capaz

No entiendo

No entendiste una mierda

Ahora me dicesn has una lista, la guardamos y la vemos en 5 años. Así que nos vemos en 5 años?

Yo prefiero que no. Me divierte la idea del experimento, pero no me diviertes vos

Entonces? Lo hago o no?

Como quieras. Ya te deje ir. Eres libre

Siempre lo fui

Tan ingenuo que eres

Que feo lo que dices

Que feo que es

Se pone mejor y peor cada vez. Quien eres.

Te dije , no me conoces. No sabes quien soy

Pero si se..

Acabas de decir lo contrario

Bueno es una manera de decir

Para, calla, vete

Que paso ahora

Tengo que Irma

A donde

A casa

Pensé que estañas en casa

No, estaba aburrida en un café, por eso decidí llamarte

Ahora soy una diversión?

No te equivoques. Dije que estaba aburrida, no que necesitaba divertirme

Ya no se que hacer, que pensar

No hagas nada . cada vez que haces algo arruinas todo.

No fui solo yo.

Pensá lo que quieras, me voy

Entonces en 5 años nos vemos

Esperemos que no

Y la lista

La lees y te acordes de mi

Y que pasa si solo pongo defectos

Pensaras que eres un tonto, 5 amos de esto mas 5 años de espera. Te domine 10 años o mas. Te maneje adentro de mi.

Que engreída que eres

Todo lo contrario. Realista. Me voy

Hace mucho te fuiste.

Por suerte. Chao



23

“Nantes” by Caroline Gabard¹⁶

After sitting on the deck totally spacing out for the better part of twenty minutes, I decided to text them.

Where are you? Still coming?

Actually I wrote,

Where r u? Still coming?

Twenty minutes for twenty years. That’s how much younger they are. I looked down into the Fanta bottle whose contents were warm, flat and near the end. Two mosquito lovers had found their way inside and were now drowning, at this very moment. Both had bushy feelers, as Ian calls them, so I assumed they were gay. Briefly, I considered whether they might actually be lesbians with strap-on bushy feelers. This thought made me annoyed with myself. Without thinking, I singly swallowed the remaining contents of the bottle. Fanta is so disgusting. This was the first and last time I ever paid for a Fanta. It was another split-second decision I made when I was in the shop on my way here. I also bought a chic-o-stic. But the Fanta was for the memory of you, you the only one I do not despise when I say bring me water and instead, you bring me Fanta. Enough about Fanta. Where the hell are they? Oh, now a text just came.

5

Maybe it will be 5, maybe it will be 10. They are 20 years younger, maybe it will be 20. They’re going to miss the sunset I thought. Well, at least the way it looks from here. But maybe they can see it from their window on the train, or would they be biking. Everything comforts me at this moment. The crane in the distance, those couple, few, scattered and proud buildings in the distance. A light in the distance. The few thin streaks of clouds in the distance. Even more comforting is the smog infused horizontal scape beyond, perfect fading stains, perfect promises of other worlds and other times. *Romantic*. All of it, all of it is on the other side of this water. Except the family of ducks swimming my way.

I had worried that the Fanta might bring everything too close. I took off my shoes, worn black oxfords. I started to remove my socks but changed my mind. These are the pale yellow ones with forest green trumpets.

Someone walked up behind me so I turned around. It wasn’t them. I sighed.

I stood up and walked back to the door. I opened the door and entered the room. It really really felt like a group assignment. There is one I am touching and sitting with. I feel like we were waiting for more instruction or something to happen. So I got up and took a closer look around the room. About eight or nine boys with shaved heads – all no older than 20, all with their shirts off, all sweating completely covered in sweat with red faces as if they were a pack of piglets shoved into an oven – were in fact all crammed and kneeling, crouching, fetal, etc. under a metal table. They looked guilty when I found them. Class-skipppers. I was quite bound up in the mood of a James Bond or some such mission, ignorant what we were all doing there. I “slept” and woke to a woman and child. The child was emaciated and starving, not more than a year old. At this point I was devastated by all the time we’d wasted on lazy and meaningless thoughts. But true to form, I resorted to inconsolable sobbing. Now and then I would see a few of the boys run by, no longer sweating, with books and binders in their arms, looking purposeful.

24

Letter to a young man

Dear Young Man,

I'm writing to you from Buenos Aires. I'm on a rooftop terrace of an old house. The first days of autumn are here, so the warm creamy light of the summer is starting to change. It's becoming cooler, more neutral, harsher. It's still as strong, but not as... I can't find the word. David Foster Wallace surely would. Anyway, what I wanted to say is that the summer light wraps you inside a cocoon of warmth. It makes you glow. The autumn light doesn't. It's strong and cold like a spotlight. It leaves the same shadow though. If you see the photo of a shadow, you cannot realize if it was taken during summertime or not. If you see the picture of light, though, you can. As I said, summer is losing ground. Autumn is slowly taking over. This change is not abrupt. Not from one day to the next. But it's there.

Last week at this time, for example, the city was hot and humid like a steam bath. One of the girls in my dancing class was complaining that she could not breathe anymore. That her skin was covered in a layer of dirt that wouldn't go. Her skin could not breathe. A few days later, as the fan in my room was on, I began to sneeze. I didn't need the fan anymore. A cool breeze had swept away the dense steam that was bathing the city. Our skins can now breathe.

I wonder what happens next at the micro level. What are the exact trajectories of the tissues and cells and atoms we are made of as autumn advances. Do they take up less space? Do the electrons, neutrons and other particles slow down their motion visibly?

I cut my nails yesterday. Time can also be perceived as an endless growing of nails. We cut them every now and then, so we get the illusion of stillness, that time has not passed, because we always see our nails as having the same length, but in reality our nails are longer all the time. Side

thought: I wonder how long would our nails be if we didn't cut them. They will be our reminders of the time passing, just like the rings of the sections of a tree's trunk are a sign of its age.

Every once in a while I see a small insect walking around one of the metal poles of this rooftop. I wonder how is it like to be an insect (more specifically ants), not to have consciousness but to have will and instinct. I wonder when these ants were born, if there is such a thing as a happy ant life. If ants born during summertime are better off than those born during the winter, if they experience heat any differently than cold. The ants I am seeing now most likely were not here at the beginning of summer, and probably will not live to the end of autumn. It's interesting how, for us, they are only "ants." We use impersonal neutral words to describe them, we do not distinguish between ant A and ant B. We do not consider each ant's individual personality. We kill them without ethical dilemmas. We do not exercise empathy towards them. If we did, we would be kinder to them. We would respect old ants maybe more than young ants. (Side thought: I wonder what is the no. 1 cause of death among ants. Cancer? Heart disease? Accidents?) Think of it, a human killing an ant (or a fly) is one of the most arbitrary and nonsensical acts of will. Be kind to ants. Time flows for them too.

Regards,

25

Letter To A Young Man

Dear Carlitos,

Thanks a lot for your hospitality last weekend. We all of us really enjoyed the stay at your station, working hard and happily on those small details and objects that are so important for our railway heritage.

I think those three days are going to be one of the most fond memories of this year that have just started, sharing your working time and mate breaks, the stories that you told about the different duties, your cooking abilities (that grilled lamb was really delicious!), the time spent with your wife and children while we were painting and refurbishing the station house, the lovely garden and, of course, the dogs.

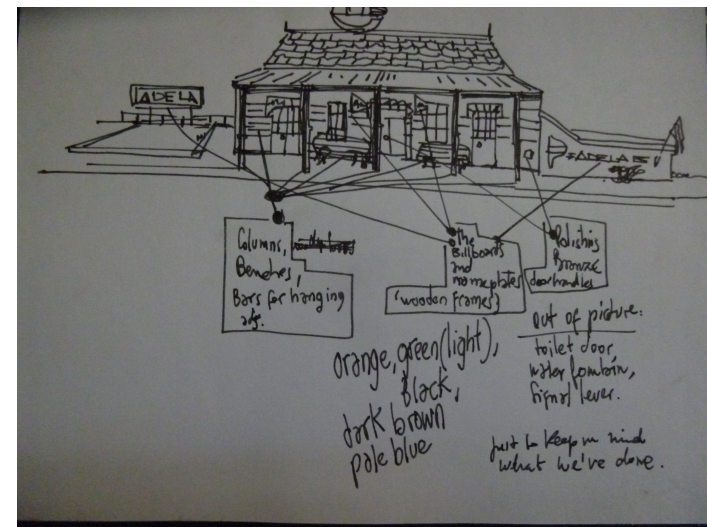
Those are the facts that I remember while writing these lines. But for sure, a lot more of all that we've lived together will come up in the near future.

I hope that we can pay you a really much shorter visit next month, when we get to Chascomús.

Please send my regards to all of your family there, especially to Nico, that let us do all that work without even knowing us.

Cheers for you now,

PS: by the way, I've got some spare parts for your 2 CV, and please don't forget to look for my sweatshirt.



26

letter to a young man

Dear Brian,

How's life in Chula Vista? Oh my gosh camp was so much fun. Like how did you manage to make braces so charismatic? Everyone is devastated.

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the color of things I want to eat

Your hair is plumbs. Your hair is taro. Your cheek is lychee. Strawberries sewn together, take a large cracker and lean it against the wall. Wheat flour is best but corn flour will also do. Distribute a fine layer inside of the basket. A lot of roast sesame seeds and a lot of pomegranate can be mixed with goat's milk and wash your face. Avocadoes are the best for your feet. Insert generous slices between each of your toes. Avoid bruising the toes. You will find, at the bottom of blue cheese. Rub a large spoonful into the left thigh and discard the rest. Follow the map to the pretzel tree which is located at the heart of the forrest. Return with a wheel barrow full of twigs and, using magic, turn the twigs into a corset. By now the avocado will have wrapped itself around the toes in the style of bacon. Everything that is ruined cannot be repaired but repair does follow ruin. I can smell honey from all the way across the room. Your ass is not a static thing. Soon it's time to add black olives to your toes. Just pop them on! If you can find a gray salt crystal the size and shape of a kidney bean,

hang it from which ever one of your ears you hear better out of. Hang from the other ear a dehydrated sphere of compacted carrot and coconut. If you have difficulty saying that one ear hears better than the other than throw both of these things in blender, add water, but do not blend! Instead observe the coconut and carrot blossom into a flower as if it were puerh. When the salt dissolves the water is the color of the sky. If you are confused try to understand that the blender has provided the necessary element of danger in which beauty may thrive.

Gently pour the contents of the blender into a large clear bowl and sit in it. The chain of strawberries can be wrapped around the neck like a choker: fasten and let the remainder fall down into the glass bowl. Some of the strawberries are bruised and breaking down. Take the opportunity to rub these and the wrists and the knees. By now you might be hearing bells. Cinnamon was added to your hair. All of the food sweats beads. They travel around the surface. I am hearing bells.

28

The secret life of Macaulay Culkin¹⁷

It's in the white of an eye says Iggy, and I agree. Why not?.

Last hollidays with the Culkins felt weird. He kept talking all the time about Michael Jackson's globes and sockets, mostly how he matched them, so particularly.

I recall meeting Macaulay in a car accident, No, it was in a busstop that I first noticed him, but we didn't stop to look at each other. There wasn't any time for that.

Whenever I think about Macaulay, I can still smell his fear, that fear of being constantly on the spotlight.

I'm sure he is playing with his Playstation or his nano toys as I write in this blue piece of paper (the original paper is blue).

I miss you so much, mostly on the telly. where are you man?

Did I tell you I was asked to write the script of home alone in the first place? I thought it was really stupid, so I turned it down. I could 've never expected I was going to be haunted for the rest of my life by that brilliant performance of yours.

Where any actors injured during the filming process? Is Joe Pesci a fucking pain in the arse? The sequel sucked.

I know you haven't been working lately, what would you do for a lot of money?.

I'm thinking of some ideas to get you into your feet again.

Have you tried acting?

I know you miss Michael, we all do..

I want you to draw some memories on Wonderland for me. I'm planning to build my own amusement park, but for older people, I don't want to get into trouble. I'll name it "You are not alone".

Why the fuck are you covering The Jesus and Mary chain?. You should give music up. You suck at it.

The last time we met you said something about losing a toe. Are you selling toes and fingers for money?. That's cool, keep doing it. Go back to hard drugs that's your thing, I'm telling you man... as a friend.. why trying so hard?.

Leave something for us Macaulay,

"You are not alone"

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The Secret Life of Macaulay Culkin¹⁸

Nobody told you where the tape was. Actually you were looking for a dog collar when you found it in the bottom of a box, things you haven't seen for a couple of years at least. The tape still sticks? The tape still sticks. You go into the bathroom and you look at yourself in the eye. And then you let out a long breath. You remove your underwear, skeptically eyeing your genitals. You tear off a piece of the tape and hold it between your fingers for a few seconds before you fasten it to the mirror. You put back on your underwear and slowly shuffle into the kitchen. You are standing in front of the refrigerator. You are wearing socks that are stretched out and somewhat falling off. Your underwear is Calvin Klein. There's a magnet on the fridge at eye level. You stick your finger in your ear and scratch it, your right ear. The magnet is the shape of a pizza slice and says "Joe's Pizza" on it, with a phone number. What were you looking for? Oh yeah, some advil. Damn, there's no more coke left in the fridge. You'll have to get a warm bottle out in the garage. There's a funny taste in your mouth and you intend to wash it down with coke rather than brushing your teeth. Actually your head really hurts, well not that bad but it hurts – if you move. And you're really tired. You open the drawer in the kitchen where you put everything you don't know what else to do with. Ah, there's the dog collar. It's not as thick as you remembered it. It has three large pointy studs, equally spaced, and a large thick metal ring that hangs down in front. You hold it up to your nose and smell it and then you put it on. Oh my God there's frozen pizza, you remember. Pepperoni and mushroom. You pull it out of the freezer and set the oven to preheat. You see the oven mit hanging on the wall and remember that you want to buy a new one. The last time Cassandra was here she used it as a gardening glove whilst repotting some plants. Cassandra has a nice ass. The last time the kitchen floor was cleaned was probably over a year ago. Your neighbors just started fighting about whose turn it is to pick up the kids from soccer practice. You never got to play on a soccer team and when you were younger. That used to bother you a lot but now you don't really think of it anymore. You run your hand through your hair – it needs to be cut – I

should do that today or tomorrow – and then you rest your right hand on your left pec. You’ve been working out with a personal trainer three times a week and you like the way you look. What’s the name of that painting by Degas with the ballerina alone in the dark, people standing in the sidelines? I guess there are a few like that. You really like that painting but you’ve never told this to anyone. The Basquiat painting you bought in 2004 is still hanging in front of your bed. After you put the pizza in the oven, you go to the bathroom and take a wiz. At the moment you flush the toilet, you realize that you really do want to brush your teeth. You kind of regret getting gold caps on your two front teeth, maybe it’s time to get rid of them. You hear your phone beeping in the other room. Alright, alright. Jimmy says he’s on his way over now and wants to know if there’s anything he should pick up on the way. Coke, cold. And a couple of candles. You just used the last you had last night. You and Jimmy met in a chat room a few weeks ago. He drives a red 1982 Porsche and works at a jewelry store. He sells jewelry. It smells like the pizza is ready so you use the oven mit to pull it out and set it on the counter. You pull up your socks and walk more briskly and purposefully back into the bathroom. You find the tape sitting on the counter where you left it and you tape both of your eyes shut.

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under the skin

The tape was wrapped around up and down the length of the finger and then, in the cuticle region, had managed to get underneath the skin. There was some discussion about what measures could be taken, whether or not it was safe to try and extract the tape with a pair of tweezers or if the risk of breakage was too high. Furthermore there existed the possibility that the tape had broken down, integrated itself, fused itself with muscle tissue and nerve. Another technique involving the bark of a fir tree had been suggested; however fir was not native to the region and was unlikely to be acquired any time soon. There may have been a number of other possibilities, but there were only two that presented themselves to consciousness. The first involved a state of deep hypnosis and meditation. If done properly, all evidence of the tape would be removed. The finger in fact would be restored. The disadvantage of attempting this lay only in the chance of confronting the impotence of one’s faith. For this reason, it was a strategy commonly avoided. The other possibility that had presented itself was the removal of the fingertip – or every part of the finger at which the tape had potentially achieved entry. This route, although seemingly carrying more extreme disadvantages than all other aforementioned, was indeed the route most commonly chosen. One could not even say “resorted to,” since that would imply that all other available measures had been exhausted, which was not the case. Nine times out of ten – as one is prone to say when pulling a statistic out of the air – it was opted to amputate. The amputee fashion of the day strictly demanded putting the dismembered appendage into a vacuum sealed transparent plastic and wearing it around the neck attached to a choker, or in a limited few more remote regions, sewing the package at the shoulder of one’s sleeve. The originary precedent for this tradition remains unknown.

Candy lay, weighing her options, on a peach-colored terrycloth, listening to the waterfall. A child entrusted to the care of the universe stood quite nearby, targeting Candy with figs from the tree under which she lay. To retain a sense of humor, she thought... to retain a sense of humor. Her

water supply had run out, baring naked her dependency on the water house. A lack of water creates a temporary dependency that ends as soon as a more fortunate proximity to water has been established. The water house changes its hours, closes and opens its doors.

As you can imagine, a variety of strategies to address this situation have arisen. Rather than listing all of them, you might as well know the only one that works demands a series of half hearted but convincing performances at the store front, during which time the image of the waterfall may never really completely leave the mind.

31

Have you studied the soft toes of geckoes?¹⁹

¿son los sentimientos puros? ¿las emociones ajustables? ¿por qué nunca yo y siempre sos vos? ¿cómo es el día de mañana? ¿será solitario? ¿estaré sola? ¿es una necesidad estar acompañado? ¿si alguien me dice como va a terminar, lo comenzaría? ¿si supieras lo mal que te va hacer, lo harías? ¿si sabemos que va a doler por que lo hacemos? ¿es la esperanza que esta vez va a ser diferente? ¿pero si siempre es igual? ¿por que seguimos con la idea que esta vez va a ser diferente? ¿por soñadores? ¿que preferimos ser, sonadores o lesionados? ¿qué es mejor el amor o la esperanza? El amor o los sueños? ¿el amor o la felicidad? ¿El amor o lo predecible? ¿quiero saber como van a ser las cosas? Quiero tener una rutina? ¿quiero tener todo lo que quiero? ¿pero, que es lo que quiero? ¿ser parte de algo? ¿que alguien será parte de mí? ¿ser parte de alguien? ¿quien soy yo? ¿qué quiero de esta sociedad? ¿qué es una sociedad? ¿qué tengo que hacer para entrar? ¿qué tengo que cambiar para ser un socio? ¿por qué no puedo ser yo? ¿por qué no puedo hacer lo que quiera? ¿soy solo yo? ¿somos dos? ¿quieres ver todo de mí? ¿quiero que veas todo de mí? ¿quiero que te lleves una sorpresa? ¿quiero que sepas como soy? ¿o voy a mostrar una versión censurada? ¿cuánto tiempo pasa para que estés adentro y no puedas salir? ¿cuánto tiempo tenemos que estar juntos? ¿es autentico lo que te muestro? ¿es la censura una mentira? ¿muestro una versión mas parecida a vos? ¿ahora no soy yo? ¿somos nosotros? ¿es necesario cambiar? ¿que pasa si no quiero? ¿que pasa si quiero ser tal cual soy y que tu seas tal cual eres? ¿me gustaste desde el primer día? ¿o fueron meses? ¿me gustabas vos? ¿o me gustaba el proyecto en el que te iba a convertir? ¿entonces quiero estar contigo o con migo? ¿a que estamos jugando? ¿tenemos miedo a la soledad? ¿nos gusta como somos? ¿estamos buscando alguien que nos ajuste? ¿por qué no lo puedo hacer yo? ¿por qué necesitamos del otro? ¿por qué si es algo tan personal y egoísta lo encubrimos con la búsqueda de felicidad, compañerismo, de amor? Yo soy yo. Yo estoy con migo. Yo se lo que quiero. ¿pero por que sigo buscando? ¿por qué me sigo exponiendo? ¿por qué? Tantas preguntas que saltan de una a otra, una se responde con otra y esto nunca se llega a

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"Have you studied the soft toes (the feet) of Geckos?" ²⁰

If I am standing by the water at Hogback, I can feel the root from a tree come up to meet the ball of my right foot in the midst of soft squishy mud where every single one of my toes are sinking. Why are there no popsicles at Hogback? I want an otterpop. Do you want a hot dog? I only speak when I have something to say. Are you lying? If you climb up on that chair and be a love you will be able to hand me that pitcher of molasses and then you will be able to sing the Star Spangled Banner and then you will be able to tap dance on your chair and then you will be able to fall to the floor and then I will be able to pour molasses all over you and then I will be able to say your name. Do you like the view? Once the light worked and when it came on all the bugs came out and did a big whirling twirling show with trapeze, whirling twirling batons, fireworks, air skating, and I heard there was a dance-off after I left. Do you suppose that will ever happen again? I want you to sit here and think about what you have done. Do you have any idea how long it took me to clean the kitchen? I would appreciate it if you wouldn't chop the onions with my suede gloves on. Did you really expect it to go any other way? Your door is open. Do you want to try this incredible recipe I just discovered? The main ingredients are salt, water and sand. Is that the beginning of a classic soup? I used to write slanted the other way. Can you remember when you started doing that and why? For sure I thought the person was cool and wanted to be a bit like them. Does it hurt if I slam the door in your face after I have grown weary of pancakes? Why should pancakes be a topic of discussion? I'm not being honest with you. Have you been completely honest with me? The next time we meet I'm going to take you to the place where I grew up. Did you ever take a nap under this tree? Some day I'm going to eat a fly without knowing it. Are you afraid of the end of the rope? When hung, the Johnny Jump Up provides endless hours of safe and healthy entertainment for your toddler. Is there anything I can do to convince you? That was the wrong question. If we began with the colors – green 2%, pink 7%, turquoise 1%, yellow 0%, tan 12%, mahogany 8%, silver a solid 20%, and white (whatever version comes

resolver. ¿quiero que se resuelva? ¿quiero una respuesta? ¿o quiero mas preguntas que me lleven en caminos que me señalan, que me dicen que van a llegar a una respuesta, cuando siempre llegan a otra pregunta? ¿ como se que no estoy en un circulo que no termina y vuelve a comenzar? ¿ o estoy en un laberinto donde tengo una salida y múltiples caminos? ¿ te necesito para que me muestres la salida? ¿ es eso trampa? ¿ te necesito o te quiero? ¿ que es el amor? ¿ que es la necesidad? ¿ o simplemente necesito querer amor? ¿ o quiero necesitar amor? ¿ quiero parte de lo mas profundo, y la necesidad es superficial? ¿ quiero o necesito? ¿ necesito o quiero? ¿ vos y yo? ¿ o yo y vos? ¿ somos una pareja? ¿ o una compañía? ¿ somos socios? ¿ o solo nos estamos acompañando? ¿ por que tenemos miedo a la soledad? ¿ que tiene la soledad que solo puede ser resuelta con tu presencia? ¿ quiero necesitar amor para eliminar el miedo a la soledad? ¿ o necesito querer eliminar el miedo a la soledad? Todos los días me digo que estoy bien conmigo, y aun así te sigo buscando, una y otra vez. Tratando de abrir la puerta con una llave parecida, todas son tan similares que necesito probar. ¿ cuando me voy a cansar de probar? ¿ o quiero haber tenido miles de pruebas? ¿ o solo quiero encontrar la que sirve? Dicen que el camino es mucho mas rico que el fin, entonces me quedo en el camino? ¿ pruebo y pruebo sin esperar un fin?? Que tan real es eso para mi? ¿ quién pretendo ser? ¿ se quien soy? ¿ estoy suficientemente fuerte para mostrarme? ¿ me quiero mostrar? ¿ o prefiero guardarme? Exponerme me hace vulnerable al rechazo, me hace notar las cosas que hago mal. Pero estas cosas me hacen que yo sea así. No quiero ser otra para vos. Quiero que sepas quien soy. ¿ me estas invitando a entrar? ¿ o me estas tratando de modificar? ¿ que porcentaje te gusta de mi? ¿ cuanto me quieres cambiar? ¿ por qué no buscas a otra y me dejas tranquila siendo yo? Yo te quiero así, te acepto así. ¿ por que debo permitir y querer cambiar para vos? ¿ quien sos? ¿ por que estas acá? ¿ o eres un obstáculo que me recuerda que tengo que pasarlo siendo yo, sin dejar nada atrás?

¿ son los sentimientos puros? ¿ es mi amor tan real como lo siento? ¿ tengo amor por el otro o amor a la idea del amor? ¿ una idea, una ilusión, no es real, pero por que te veo aquí conmigo? Tan real como el deseo. ¿ Qué es mas real que el deseo?

to mind) clocking in at a whopping 70%, what precisely are we left with? I'm tired of his jokes. Did you regret yourself when he never told a joke again? Sometimes you might begin to get the feeling that you're running out of time. Are you satisfied with everything I've given you? I believe we have it in two sizes: small and large. Shall I go back and check? I'm making dinner. Do you want some? Agnes looks out the train window onto blurry fields of cows swimming in a green sea and recalls the scene in the Little Mermaid where Ariel combs her dark red hair with a dinglehopper. If you had a choice between Texas and The Mets, what'd it be? Come on, I need you guys to wake up and get out here on this field and play some ball! How many blue ribbons do you have? I can't remember if she went that way or that way. Was there a time when you knew where you were? I would eat a chicken. Must there be conditions for everything? Look: when the sun sets, the clock strikes.

33

The Interrogative Mood²¹

Have you studied the soft toes of a gecko? If yes, when? How was the texture of their skin? What were the shapes, the patterns? Do they look like anything familiar? Are they of pentagonal shape, hexagonal, octagonal or simply irregular shape? Is it angular or rather free-flowing lines? I didn't even know geckoes have soft toes, what is the opposite of soft toes, is it hard toes? Does the gecko have some special substance on its toes that enables it to stick to the walls? Does a nameless gecko make me feel more uncomfortable than a normal one? What would be the most appropriate name for a gecko? Do geckos have personalities, are there sad geckos and happy ones, extroverted and introverted geckos? Do geckos feel homesick? Can a gecko be a pet? Would it feel tenderness towards its owner? Could a gecko love me? Are geckos easily bored? If not, what are the favourite pastimes of a gecko? Do they like to play games? Do they have a love life? A professional life? If the gecko in my room had a job, what would I be? Are there jobs that require one to have the personality of a gecko? Do geckos hear sounds the way we do? Do they like music? Can the Mozart effect appear in a gecko? Does music make them feel angry or frustrated or just relaxed? Does music physically hurt them? Can geckos feel anger? Can they feel trust? Can they feel tenderness? If I had two geckos, one named Mike and one named Spike, would they be able to tell the difference? What flavours does a gecko like for its food? What are the qualities that a male gecko considers attractive in a female gecko? What about the other way around? What are the other people here writing about right now?

The gecko in my room. How many hours per day does a gecko sleep? Where does it sleep? Does it know my routines? Does it see me coming and going every day? Is it a he or a she? Both humans and geckos can be either male or female. Both look for each other, both hunt for food. Humans and geckos are the same thing, none is more entitled to live on this Earth than the other. My home as a human is perfectly fit to be his home as a gecko. Geckos do not abide by human laws.

If geckos had a Constitution what would the first article be? All geckoes shall be equal regardless of colour, size, sex, colour of their eyes or pattern of their soft toes? Would it speak about gecko matters?

It is so difficult to un-be human. We are so used to being human that we cannot even imagine a world that would not copy our human world.

What is one thing that all geckoes do, and that a human would never do?

Am I the owner of the gecko in my room, or is it my owner? I want to protect that gecko. To make sure it doesn't get hurt. I'm pretty sure the gecko doesn't want to be protected though. It doesn't feel it's my property. The gecko does not need my displays of affection.

34

No articles, no pronouns, no adjectives, no adverbs.

Martin went home and had dinner outside. Beer was pouring. Martin got drunk and started singing songs praising God. Martin drank wine, beer, whisky and tequila. Martin enjoyed all drinks. Sarah was waiting for Martin back home, arms crossed and eyes in tears. Martin slipped because of garbage. As Martin was lying down, blood started flowing from Martin's nose. Sarah didn't imagine what was going on. Sarah cooked chicken with chickpeas, tomatoes, rice and spinach. Martin used to love that. Martin lost consciousness. Martin froze. Martin was rescued by kids. Martin didn't remember names, addresses, memories. Martin's memory was erased, like deleted files on computers. Sarah turned on Martin's laptop. Password was requested. SMTricer05**\$tops. Sarah, Martin, Triceratops. Gerry loved dynosaurs. Gerry dreamed of going to Argentina. Sarah opened Martin's e-mail. There were messages from Frank. Martin's boss. Nothing more. Sarah ate chicken stew, but left some for Martin. Gerry had already gone to sleep. Sarah couldn't. Martin was in hospital. Sarah turned on TV. Martin was on TV.

Recipe for disaster. Ingredients:

- 5 pints of beer
- 6 glasses of wine
- 1 bottle of whisky
- 7 shots of tequila
- pinch of salt
- zest of one lemon
- hurry
- 1 slice of winter
- 1 car
- 7 pedestrians
- 2 trucks
- one crossroad
- multiple layers of ice
- zero attention

Mix all ingredients in two bowls. Fry then bring to boil. Never allow temperature to drop, not even by one degree. Disaster will follow. Report disaster on news.

Kidneys hurt. Martin's kidneys were destroyed. No alcohol anymore. No more beans. Lots of watermelons. Sleep. Get enough sleep. Is "enough" adverb? I hope not. Lars von Trier would make films with criteria listed. Lars von Trier would love Elizabeth's restrictions. Lars von Trier would go to Mars. Mars von Trier. Films by Mars von Trier. Films by Mars von Venus. Men are from Mars, women are from Venus, P is from Saturn. P has seen Saturn's rings in Chile. Women love Uranus and dream of going to another planet. Men are from Earth, women are from Perth. Perth, Australia. Never been to Australia. But have been to sister country, Austria. Only penguins live in Antarctica. No humans. Before going to Mars, humans could colonize Antarctica. Plant crops in Antarctica. Make music in Antarctica. Make music, not war. Wars against Antarctica are against air, land and ice. Ice would fight. Air wouldn't. Air. Flair. P is looking for words with rhymes. Words with spouses, brothers, sisters, in-laws. Word in-law.

Salad with kiwi. Recipe for fruit salad.

- apples
- pears
- plums
- watermelons
- Mars bars
- kiwi

Mix all ingredients. Kiwi should be without feathers. Roasted. Mars bars are fruit. Mars bars grow in bushes.

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loud enough

Walking over the worn and faded astro-turf out near the pool area always causes the toes to curl back just ever so quietly. There is an odor that crescendos when the surface is damp and stewing in the sun. An itch at mezzo piano will linger. The plastic/rubber strips of the reclining patio/lounge chairs are mezzo forte when your skin first touches them. And they leave perfectly audible impressions upon the back of your thighs when you get up. A young girl wearing a pink and yellow Minnie Mouse swimsuit executes a pianissimo dive into the pool. Pianissimo requires the maximum skill and energy. Forte is the most common. Almost everything is forte. A delayed and distorted voice announces that lunch is ready: tuna sandwiches, grapes, triscuits, and banana cream popsicles for dessert. This interrupts the Nancy Drew book that traveled the silent distance. Whirling siren mezzo falling in acceleration decrescendo to fortissimo fatigue. The volume of gravity and associated fluctuating perception of pain. The flight of the whispered. Hushed and loud whispers, loud enough to create aqua power. Solar power is either mezzo or forte. That's all. Quietly walking up the hill. Loudly calling down. Eyes that are set to 10db. Knowing what without making a sound. Tell me again I can never remember, Is it volume that is infinite or is it silence?

36

No Articles, No Pronouns, No Adjectives No Adverbs

Mount Timpanogas stands on redness. Redness under tanness, greenness, blueness and darkness. Television laughs and breathes and eats spaghetti. Spaghetti softens hearts. Porcelain broke by Cane. Time in Florida is time with baby for cruising, dancing, collection. Cat tells wartime pink is neat. Colors are old. Newspaper meets airplane in clouds, above rivers, under stars. Mothers cry. Boys have eyes. With cherishing comes dinnertime. Favoritism wins. Winning above gold. Matt Damon births Ben Affleck's child and Ben Affleck births Matt Damon's child in water. Love childed father. Leg stretches joke. Joke in box for ten. Ben folds five. Five alive in heaven. Seven is named. Functioning by perception is ruled. Ruled to court by death. Dying is Time. Suck cock. Take cake in S. Kindness for change and climbed Mount Fuji in July. Dreams live and bugs die. Ant crawls under sleeve. Sleeve folds on trick. Magic costs money. Freedom risks and love risks and life risks and social-security regrets. Give two. Give four. Everything for soup and nothing for revolution. Trickling is fickleness. Suckling is childhood. Canned for God is Daisy's brat. Suck for change. Time is place. Try carrots for beets. Prove excitement for shouldering casserole and weathervaning dessert. Eat privilege or sand castles. Castles on clouds, castles with boats in motes. Games are played. Naps do not end. Bones never bend after ten. Ten is enough. Always is forever. Dreams aren't times, dreams are places. Travel to summit. Meet at peak. Desire by tree. Mosquito sucks blood. Woman shows cards. Fun in footing could drown but float or butterfly. Smells smell. Touches touch. Come at nine for dinner. Wake at noon for surprise. Sleep with broom after sweeping palatiality. Downey sifts detergent on time. Not on time is haircut, cooking or whip. Help newness, Help heariness. Be deariness. Canceled is school. Schooled is reindeerred. Reindeerred is Eeyore. Piglet disdains rudeness. Trying for worlds. Backs and swords. Victory slides home, makes not sense, is not correct. Why is devil? Browned are thumbs, players are sayers. Tryers are buyers. Chewers and swallowers compete. Finality ripping threads does. Cheating is common. Licorice was blackened. Is life truedom? Can Kingdom rise in morning? Drowning or sinking. Fish saved baby. Words are rules.

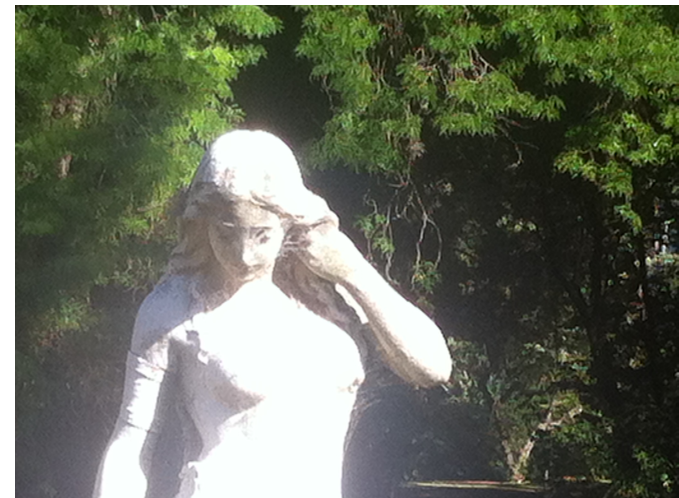
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Pizza Suicide TV Live²²

Hello, hello, hello. I should be able to hear me. I should be able to hear myself. I keep talking. You are good. You are good... comentario, ai, ja, ja, ja. PSCTV is back. Honey Boo Boo Child. Ich bin Mario Campos... elemento.. bale, bale bale, porque si, que pasa? What's up? What's happening? ... yeah? No, no no. There's not music right now. I'm waiting for instructions. Yeah you can swap microphones. Wow. Ok. Now. That's something new. I ate Asian Soup. It's called Tom Kow. [signal interrupted] and like... [signal interrupted] PSCTV will be right back with you shortly. XXX tv.pizzasuicideclub.com ... [buffering] ... black after work can't ya hear the wind blow. Set the book like the look set for you in this very dear... drums, saxophone, flute and bass. Camera zooms to a dark face, camera pans... sound cuts. Frame freezes. [,,] A man was almost dancing. Zooming in and out, television in the back. Another television on the floor... driving down the long road.. apple tune. Ah yes, some more.... It's going it keeps going. It's called Gratitude Attitude by the Gray Voice Ensemble. A girl with glasses named Leo takes a sip of wine in a red room. I'm not ready for that yet. A girl with green hair takes a sip of wine and smiles. Tell me the big deal tell me the big deal tell me the big deal, I have to tell you all, a person with short blond hair runs their hand through it and takes a sip of beer. Snaps on 2 and 4. Saxophones and bass, buh-budda, bah, bu, duh. All I'll ever talk about is your style. Undercover on the run it was fun. Gratitude that attitude, candles, pink, orange and green light. When the shit came down I stood up and I declared my love for you, takes a drag of cig. Sound cuts, pin, pon, ding, flute. They're telling secrets, I cannot see their faces. Now is the flower shirt of Mario Campos. Now is some perverted gesture of Harmony Molina. Now a man lines up bottles. Harmony holds the microphone. Ping. And hugs the man in white shirt and beige blazer. Medicinal Spirits... yes his microphone is not on. We're live. It's life. Peter presentaré, cinco quateo, trés, dos, uno Peter. Guten Tag meine Damen und Herren. Check the mic hello that one should be better, Peter adjusts his collars. Are you sure about that? Hey - we're late. Ah, ah - yes. You got me a quarter inch plug. Alright. Ping. Uh-huh. Well, for that we need sound.

And sound is the new responsibility of (indiscernible) if this be real there's a place we can go that I know. A blue girl sips her drink. Sound cut, frame freezes, a blonde haired person sits in chair and blue haired girl sprays the blonde hair and strokes the head. No yes? No yes? Cumpleaños.. manos grandes... blue haired girl puts a cape around blonde person and combs the hair. Hello? Ping... blue hair girl begins to cut. They are both smiling. You are my sanctuary. They give me a red shirt... they swim in flowers. Leo in a red jacket, closeup of girl's profile and zoom in out as she talks to a boy and sucks on a cigarette. Chat and ping sounds. The bass is much louder than I thought. The room is dark. Plug in. Keyboard is played. Screen splits to see haircut above and white blazer man sound checking below. Blue hair girl flicks a chunk of hair to the ground. Blazer man blows into the mic. Some may say hay babe you're making yourself sick. She cuts around the ear. Screen unsplit and we lose blazer man. Blue hair girl explains and gestures with her left hand. She lifts hair at the crown of the head and cuts across. That's very satisfying. Uhhh... one more. What are we going to do after that? I dunno. Play something else. Bear a child for us we can dream you can be vicious and it shows. But do not bear them without cause. I want a haircut too. That's a nice feeling. The blonde person takes a sip of beer. They discuss bangs, called ponies in Germany. It begins from the beginning again. Afternoon communication, Leo gestures with the Blazer man. Garden in the closet, booze in a garden diorama that hangs with a light on the wall. Blazer man checks his cards and straightens his collars. Lina says hello and waves. Things against the wall are discussed. The haircut continues. Apple tune, da, dah, dah, etc. the bottom of the hairline is thinned and blended. Synthesizer sounds ping – Fats Waller and the joint is jumping, my my they have a new expression... hear somebody shout, dances are poppin, check your weapons @ the door, the neighbors are knocking ahh yah – ah no son, that ain't the play, I mean this joint is jumpin. Grab anybody's daughter I mean this joint is jumpin gimme the pony eyebrows – uh oh, steel drums? Nice, nice I like it. Bill Robinson and Fats Waller perform Madonna on the Jonathan Ross show Feb. 26th 2015. I hear if I talk. The haircut continues. Do you have something on your computer? No I don't have the thing anymore. Ah, shit. Well alright nine minutes until the show starts. Quiero presenta. Blonde takes a sip. This haircut is looking good. Quando... esta chicita – o si, es corra la... quanto – ay yeee eeeeeee, quando todo – para la, burrito qua, fade out. snip snip behind the ears. Leo passed in front of the camera carrying a glass of wine. Blazer man looks ready, sitting on the shiny red couch behind the glowing globe lamp on the red coffee table. Porque – ente nido e mi, pelo – la lo – col, y me pre gunta, la la la, ya vo la si, oh le a si si que a chi son, porque ni

es mi, three minutes. Juanita banana, e muy tranquilo, bonita Juanita, con tara – Junaita banana... como canta, Juanita Banana Juanita Banana Juanita Banana Juanita Banana. Blazer man yawns and stretches his shoulders. He picks up the cue cards, another blue haired girl takes a drag of a cigarette. Sound cuts, frame freezes, continues. A group stands waiting frame freezes. Blazer man welcome to the show in Rixdorf.



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Tips For The Future

In the future, a cow lays on its side, a single tear falling from its right eye. In the future I suggest you include all your cash each time you do a load of laundry. In the future I think it would be better if you parted your hair on the other side. Save all your rubber bands, there will be a ban on them in the future. Prepare yourself to live in a house that is actually made of glass. Pastel floral wallpaper is on its way back (whereas pastel trousers have again unmistakably become a thing of the past). In the future, I recommend clipping your nails and leaving them on the kitchen table if you want to make someone barf. Counting by five is the way of the future and the reason why is inflation. "Pajama" will be another word for "dance", as in, do you like to pajama? Not even a specific dance but dance in general. This happens some time in the 23rd century. Because (insert your favorite food) will be the most common and widely available food in the future, you might want to consider how you want to deal with it and prepare accordingly; it might be more disappointing than you realize. Taking into consideration the amount of rocks, the amount of dead rats, the amount of ammonia of cat piss, the amount of blue sky, marshmallows available at the supermarket and the privacy you maintain in the midst of Satan sitting on a fence eating chocolate covered strawberries, the future looks quite bright. One thing you could do in the future is wear a wig and/or eyepatch; suggestions like these are often taken for granted. If your future face has a pimple, you take your future chances popping it. The group of large bushes underneath the small plexiglass overhang will exceed their container but their hearts will continue to expand and so my advice is now and in the future to recognize the meaning of the opportunity that faces you in this very moment. What goes along with this is that in the future you will be just as bad a liar to your feelings as you are now if you should choose to lie to them, but your options remain the same in the future as they are now, insofar as these things are concerned. A future umbrella held a bit higher will not gouge out the eye of someone you call your friend. A future pancake smothered in butter and maple syrup when the sun is coming up will make you feel so very emotional, but because you don't care if they see

you cry or you are alone in the future, this concludes all of the advice I have for you.

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Tips for the future

It's a lot easier to write in hindsight, tips for what would have been you, or tips for your teenage self, than tips for the future.

I need to make this more specific.

If Earth becomes overpopulated and you are offered a one-way ticket to Mars and all the money in the world, don't take it. They don't have good music on Mars.

If aliens come and try to make contact with you, don't panic. Remember, you've been curious all along as to how they look/feel/sound/smell like. Keep a detailed diary, then use it and write a book about the experience.

Take particular notes of the alien smells, it's not something the media talks about a lot. What if they stink? Bring a dog along. Maybe even a cat. If they like the alien, it can be trusted.

If you ever win a million dollars in the lottery, invest in what would be a present-day Noah's Ark. Noah was one of the first environmentalists of mankind, fighting for the preservation of the animal species threatened by pre-historic global warming. So do as he did, capture a male and a female of that species, build a habitat for them and make them breed. If another big religion arises one day, you will be mentioned in their sacred text. I think it's worth the investment.

Keep recipes of all of mum's cakes. The world is currently undergoing a globalisation of deserts. The good old local cakes with nuts and jam and almonds and all those complicated creams are becoming extinct. New species such as the lemon-pie, the double-chocolate brownie and the blueberry cheesecake are taking over. Darwinistically speaking, this is unfair. It's not the survival of the fittest/tastiest, but a Monsanto-like manoeuvre to achieve uniformization. Resist it.

Speaking of Monsanto, have you noticed that there are fewer types of apples in the markets than they used to? The world is also going through a globalization of fruit and vegetable species driven not by natural selection laws, but by market forces. Capitalism is killing our flavours. Do not let that happen. Plant a tree of each type of apple that you cannot find on the market. The early summer golden apples with a flourish texture that do not last more than a few days. The late autumn apples that never grow too big and have a sour taste. They nevertheless resist low temperatures and can be preserved the whole winter.

Write every day when you are happy and when you are not happy either.

Do not give up your attempts at world domination at any cost.

If a fortune-teller offers to guess your future, do not shy away. Fortune-tellers may not be the best scientists, but they can make great storytellers. Go to a fortune-teller in all the countries you visit and write a book.

Re-read the diary entries you kept 10 years before on the same day. React to them.

If you find a message in a bottle coming your way to the shore, think twice before opening it. It most likely wasn't addressed to you, but to a siren. If you are a siren, open it immediately.

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Atienda el teléfono con voz animada²³

Wheezing breath builds up to a barrel laugh building up to one long wheezing exhale, loud nostril inhale and descending melodious sigh and finally matter-of-fact, “you don’t say... you don’t say.” Thick fingers scratch around the short thinning hair of the head, a few flakes of dandruff flutter to rest on a boldly festive red and white patterned cotton button-up shirt. “Well, I’ll tell ya what... that is about the most fantastic thing I ever heard... I just...” The thick fingers scratch around the jaw and hover over the right cheek, all very cleanly shaved. “See that’s the thing, I just. can’t. get that image out of my mind... I mean, what a hoot... what. a. hoot. That absolutely has got to be the single most incredible thing, I just... I mean, you gotta love it. You’ve just got to love it, right? A ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! ... ha! ha! Oh stop! Get outta town. You’re killing me. O... my... goodness. I did *not* even *think* about that. You have *got* to be kidding me. Priceless, absolutely priceless. Well, it just doesn’t get any better than that, am I wrong? No, no... I mean, well,” A foot slid out of its polished oxford and felt the cooler room temperature make contact through a damp burgundy sock, “Well, I tell ya what, You guys are just gonna have to come on over again. Marsha will be thrilled. I’m sure of it!” The fingers scratched at the socked foot and then rested briefly on the heavy faux wood desk before attempting to pry out a string of roast beef between two teeth a ways back, left over from lunch. A left over roast beef sandwich. “Yeah? ... u-huh? Sure.. mm-hmm... yes, I do think I know what you mean. I do not expect that should be a problem at all... not a thing. Well, I mean, what are friends for? ... a-ha! ha! ha! ha! no, you betcha. That is *my* pleasure. No, no, that is absolutely not a problem at all. Glad to do it. Glad to do it... oh, what’s that? O, no no no. That just isn’t necessary! No I mean it! Please, don’t be ridiculous, Marsha and myself would just be delighted!” Leaning back in the chair, both feet went up on the top of the desk, both the socked and the shoed. The socked pushed off the shoe and both feet stretched out revealing small holes around the big toe of each sock. “Tell me, do you guys still make it down the canyon on weekends now and again?” The fingers were pulling off the socks. Both heels were dry and cracked. All the nails were yellowed

and overgrown. The toes squiggled around and played with each other. “Ah-ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! ha! Now ain’t. that. the truth. No tellin’ *what* those kids are up to. That is just a hoot. I mean that *just* takes the *cake*. That is absolutely fantastic.” The head leaned back further and the eyes closed. The mouth remained open, smiling, the head nodding, the smile getting wider, relaxing, then expanding again.” Well that is *really* the most fantastic thing I have ever heard. What. a. hoot.” The eyes opened slowly and the head came up and the feet came down to the floor. The body sat up straight. The eyes moved around the room, “Hey – hey, I am so sorry but I think I might have to cut this short – I just realized the time and well, you know, there’s a game on. ... a ha! ha! ha! ha! ... Well, I shoulda known you’d be watching too... That’s fantastic. Just fantastic. It is absolutely wonderful to talk to you my friend, and let’s do it again real soon. I meant what I said. Think about later this month, myself and Marsha would love it... absolutely... I will do that... you betcha my friend. That’ll be great. All right, you too. A ha! ha! ha! ha! Absolutely. You bet. Alright. You have a great evening and we’ll talk again soon.... Alright. Bye bye now.

41

Dusting and making love

Dust was my greatest fear since I became a housewife. Each corner of the house reminded me of my poor job dusting the house. At first I dusted every week, then the gap between the cleaning got shorter, then disappeared.

Making love was my greatest pleasures since I became a housewife. Each room in the house reminded me of the great job I was making. At first we made love every day, then the time gap got bigger and turned infinite.

Peacocks use their feathers to mate. We use their feathers to dust.

42

Making love and dusting

Sex and swiping

Grab Trap the bat. Let go the rats from the hat.
and if the cracks are full of rust, Swipe.

es coger(fuck) realentizar la realidad, tratar no es hacer y pensar no es limpiar.

Al fin, el polvo te acompaña, y que sentido tiene pasar un plumero hecho de recuerdos.

Lets go back to the stop.
to be is to live, to live is to die. the rust becomes dust.
cut the crap

43

Dusting and making love

Dusting can be a way of making love to the atmosphere. It is more than simply removing particles of “dust” (fibers of skin, hair, plant, animal, mineral, etc.) with a cloth. It is rearranging the energy. It is giving some love and awareness to the space around you, as a gift of gratitude for those around you and to yourself and most of all to the sacredness of a space itself. When you dust you touch things. You give them your energy. You move them around and reconnect with their meaning. Watching someone rearrange a mantelpiece, dashboard, table, etc. (have you ever)

Of course there is also loveless dusting. Loveless dusting is more a raping of space. I am sad for those who do this. To lovelessly dust is to leave a space uninspired. You have failed to let it touch you.

I'm not trying to say that those who lovelessly dust are devoid of love. I'm just making an observation about waste and neglect of the vibrancy of things.

Also, the full potential of a feather duster is commonly overlooked.

Are there times when the dust is better left untouched? Of course. This is ancient wisdom also not well tolerated by the antiseptic age. Excessive dusting is no enrichment for the soul. The key to this lies in the definition of excessive and how this relates to the gentrification of the soul.

44

Dusting and making love

Dusting IS making love. Removing the dirt, and the impurities, and everything that has gathered over time on the immaculate surface of the object you love. Rendering it shiny, making it impeccable again, as if days and weeks had not passed over it. Giving it back its power to seduce, making it feel new. Rendering it its best skin, so that when a ray of light brushes it from a side, the foreign eyes will not see layers of dust, but a perfectly polished surface. Treating it gently and with care, not to hurt it, respecting it and treasuring it. Knowing that the accumulated impurities are not part of the object's essence, but something that can be wiped away. Then, one day, you drop the object of your love while you're dusting it, and it breaks. Its perfection is gone and cannot be retrieved with all the effort in the world.

45

Great Expectations²⁴

Things are always what they seem. It's just us that we twist our visions to feel different, to doubt, to have our own voices.

In the darkness, a complete darkness, such values don't count, and things remain things. The difference is we can't see them.

There's a warm feeling around the idea that we can change it all, well, we don't need to.

When the spell is over, then you'll see what life is made of. Until that day, we can drink a wine, have a walk, have a conversation and enjoy every difference we find in the way.

I'm looking forward.. but I don't have to.. I'm ok, living the day, life I mean, for now.

So.. any plans for the future?, I have a lot. I'll tell you about them, but in the future... if we still remain the same people.

46

Great expectations²⁵

Mellow. Sound. Piano. Music. Rhythm. Tone. Band. Fame. Orchestra.
Chorus. Singer. Songwriter. Producer.

Walking from a to b seems never to end. Expecting what will become of me? What will others think of me? Moving. Journey from a to b. is there a middle point? Expecting the end point or the journey?

The air was cold. The breeze was ending, or beginning? Mellow I felt, calm I became. Moving. Journey. Electric feeling in my spine. It triggers and starts low back to neck. Hot. Cold. Feeling. Electric. Nervous. The journey.

It already began, when would it end. A to B. B to A. will it happen? Will it be the same? Parallel journey. Symmetrical. A like. Half's.

Do I need B to A to really acknowledge A to B. Can I have one without the other. Wrong? Right? Journey. Morning. Travel. Process

Do I need to go to B. Can I stay here calm, mellow, meditative, pause freeze.

Don't want to stop. Don't want to make a decision. Will it be A or B. can I stay? Can I stay here and acknowledge the nothingness.

A to B. I stay in the middle. Fast forward. I still.

Freeze. Still. Happy. Happy to be here. Happiness. Joy. Joyful. Now. Don't care about B. want to be here now. Here Now. Present.

What about Z. go backwards? Before. Past. There. A while. Other. I'm other. Transformed. Change. But if I'm still, will I change? The surrounding will do that for me environment. Others. Un familiar. Familiar. They change. Will I have to change to understand? Time. Clock. Minutes.

Passing by walking. Never hurry. There/s no hurry. B will come.

B will always be.

47

Great Expectations²⁶

I was listening to Liszt's Hungarian Rhapsodies today while I was cooking. Every once in a while I like to do that. It reminds me of my childhood.

We used to have a vinyl record player in the living room. And about 200 vinyls with classical music. My dad held classical music in great esteem. Our living room was something like a sanctuary, and playing those vinyls was the sacred ceremony performed in it.

I would let my dad know that I wanted to listen to one. Some were really child-friendly. My dad would tell me to sit quietly on the couch and I would obey. On the wall opposite to the couch, there was a library. On each side of the library, symmetrically, a loudspeaker.

My dad insisted that I sit right in the middle of the couch, at equal distance from each of the loudspeakers. Not an inch to the right or left. Then he would press Play and sit next to me. We would sit still and listen to the recording religiously, without speaking, until the end. There were famous orchestras and orchestra conductors, renowned pianists and violinists.

When I was 10, my parents thought I should develop my love for classical music and take piano lessons.

They were as boring as could be, but I did everything they asked me to, rehearsed an hour each day, while feeling guilty that I wasn't rehearsing for eight, like great pianists do.

Guests would come into our house and I invariably, had to play for them. I felt like a monkey on display. The tracks played would be Beethoven's Fur Elise, and if Christmas was approaching, Silent Night.

I stopped taking piano classes after four years, when my parents decided I should focus on my studies, the "serious" ones, instead. I was relieved.

Listening to classical music is not a ritual in my life anymore, but something I play casually on my Iphone while cooking. I can listen to Liszt, Chopin, Schumann, Rachmaninov or anything. I deliberately avoid Fur Elise.

48

Great Expectations²⁷

When you lower the bar it's disappointing.

A summary of aims contemporary and relevant to yourself in the sense of "what was it you wanted to do" might be, well, summarized in remaining on the surface, exercising without strain, listening (classic), fighting for the side of inwardness, creating some kind of record, avoiding (although you do sometimes give into) referentiality, and finally, in summary, going back to kindergarten.

Expectation waxes and wanes. It is the opposite of pointless. Without, the world is shit. There is no moon. Apparently there is also no sun.

A t-shirt with the words "Great Expectations" written on it, is faded.

She kissed him in a bad way at the fountain in the sun and it broke his heart.

It disappoints to disappoint. Why don't you shuffle the deck and pour us a glass of cognac.

With some you could begin. With some you want to begin. With some beginning is inconceivable. With some you just begin. Flip an egg and I'm yours.

49

The Language of the Body²⁸

What would happen if you remembered to breathe?

Dreams of being pressed until the pressure is gone. Not by you. By them. By the outside. Elevators working by weight and weight alone, the weight of gravity. An elevator that keeps ascending does not stop until the clouds. The clouds are the top floor. They look like your muscles. All the shapes of your muscles. You are doing construction. I can hear your heels clicking actually banging on my front door. Then she tells me how to make the front door disappear. I want to lie down with the weight of seven guitars pressed upon my body and I say No! You should hold this now! Bang bang bang! I don't care if you're disappearing I'm training you. Slap! Bang! At Disneyland there is a ride called the Matterhorn. It is a roller coaster. The cars creak up a steep path you can feel and hear the machinery engaging. It's a lot of metal touching itself and each other in ways that reroute your path. A white hairy beast jumps out and you begin your desperate cries again.

Let me off Let me off Let me off. Feel and hear. These two things. Dogs start joining in barking this is the new rhythm, over before it begins so you can chase it. But you really need to relax. You don't know if the light or the dark is watching you. How many minutes until language ceases. Until words cease. A professional massage. Plank. Diving into a pool.

The language of food poisoning. What is it supposed to mean? You have a few words but only a few. Is this how you choose to use them? If language is my social clothing, taking it off is like (walking under the bridge.) Get it? This body is ridiculous. Pleasure. Frustration. Count to 100 and then back down again. Steer your competitive glance across the table and put one hand firmly on its corner, focusing your eyes to show you are coming, leaning forward a predator. Your feet, your knees, the hair on your legs, goats in the forest, dreaming again. No not dreaming again. The air smells like frogs, the path down sounds like frogs. The air is the color of

frogs. To turn around and face this you are defeated by language it's the one you close your eyes to and wait for to be kissed. Ten. Nine. Eight. Seven. Six. Five. Four. Three. Two. One. Zero. Bang, clop clop stomp thud bang, slap, bang, hammer hammer ham thud breathe mud brick metal tap tap jingle hammer thud horse cklopf-dumm bum, tack, stat, stack, brick, brick brick, brick, neck, brick, saw, whisper, whistle hum, jingle tap, nail, scrape, flicker, light, tin. Pans, spoons, pots, stairs, heels, bark, barking, horns, forks metal, pans steps, up, hollow, bright, spring, breaks, whine, whistle, scrape, bang, jingle, clud, thud, thod, wood, bang, rock, air, cars, waves, air, whistles, umbrella, dough, slapping, cash, nails, hammer, do, new, gesundheit, floor, hammer, bang, thud, hammer, bang, thud, metal, harmony, falling, sky, stairs, descending, metal, banging, banging, eternity, scrape, lightly, lighter, brushes, metal, toss, stairs, descending, heavy, trickle, slinky, next, fire, ignite, engage, hammer, shuffle, hands, hammer, bright, inside, hollow, horse, clopping,

and then look at the window. look out the window spinning out. Don't be afraid to try.

50

a study uv language²⁹

Now I have a serious question for you. Does the fascia live in the skin or the way the skin says it? Do you mean to pull the fascia away from the muscle for any purpose, with any technique or skill? Do your hands fly wildly for wildness incorporated dot com or is the necessary gesture for maintaining balance as you walk a taut rope. Teach me the ways of the rope. Learn me the art of actual body message.

What's the part of my voice that makes ya gag? Which tonic angle hurts your feelings?

I kinda do like to make a gag in the room. The one I will not offend does a merry jig and fiddles their pudding at the dinner. And I tell you it's a guess. A gas produced butterfly, in representation of all your art rejects.

Bill your beef with poetry or are you a vegetarian? I am neither. There's no guarantee that you and I are going to get along.

If we both snort a line of Ridalin, it should increase the chances? Poppycock. Amen.

You are interested in the retension of Bartleby's declination in its potential construance as sacrilege as if Bartleby could be a style of music.

I am interested in the retension of the sacred in its possible manifestation in Bartelby's declination.

I'm not convinced that every house must be torn down in order to be inhabitable, I prefer decay to deconstruction. Este mas natura.

Misunderstandings often lead to revelations. Getting mad is probably pointless.

Letz play games. Interkulchural trans nash-anal pay chance. Patience. What shud bee ron? What shud bee ben? Dad and ben? Ron and good? James and hatred? Lolly and gag? Me with a spoon? Batman nat, shall we ask them when it is gone too far, when the hens have leff the coup, when the singing fat is still lady?

Do the math and tell me is there any more political effort to be made? Or can we go back to juggling broken bah bah black sheep have ya any woes. Have you any foes? Did you win them or lose them? Will you discard them or use them? Interruptions generated by Bad Bros jusss wanna ewe to have a bad day Sandra. Don cry Sandra don feed the sheep Sandra, Sandra the wind will carry ewe away. Sandra it's all in the flick of the rich. I aim. I aim. I aim.

to be poor. Revolooooshunize the fruits of the loom. Paupers in paradise. It's two soon for English. The world is needs many languishes. Not so penny Americana regressamenté salutado embraysado chula tigua sontiahuevando chigua chellaverte. Joy y pain y sunshine y rain. Countdown de la lingua.

51

Rope in the palm of their hand³⁰

Como me gustaría ser mar. El agua. El agua la brisa y el mar. Placer. Pero si es trabajo cambia la connotación? lo conocí un verano cuando trabajaba en la playa. Yo hacia algunos postres y atendía un puesto en la playa. La llegada de los barcos me traía alegría siempre esperaba alguna aventura. nunca pasaba mas de los clientes usuales o gustos particulares. Nada me llamaba mucho la atención. Siempre seguía con la esperanza que algo ocurriera , y no se trataba de amor. Se trataba de algo que me sacara de ahí, me sacara mentalmente. Y no era que me sintiera atrapada, pero por alguna razón estaba ahí, sin poder salir por mi propia voluntad. Entonces llego el. Bastante mayor, con un aspecto que no llama la atención, pasaba desapercibido con todos los que recorrían el lugar.

No había nada especial en el, a simple vista era mayor y eso me hizo verlo de una manera bastante paternal. Veía un hombre seguro y fuerte, lo tuve que asociar a mi padre. Nunca pensé que el fuera a ser mi aventura de la temporada.

Sabia todo lo que pasaba en el mundo, podía citar a os mas famosos escritores, poetras, filósofos. Me llevo, me transporto fuera de mi lugar. Esta era la aventura que necesitaba. un viaje mental, recorrer el mundo como el lo hacia pero desde mi cómodo lugar.

Día a día se fue haciendo mas notoria nuestra relación. Todos nos conocíamos, y todos hablaban. Los rumores se corrían y estaban todos felices de mi abandono a la soledad y comenzaban las preguntas de cuando el casamiento y un hijo y finalmente la mudanza de este lugar.

Nadie se pregunto que era lo que yo quería. Nadie entendía que mi vida en soledad me llenaba de felicidad. Y que el para mi era solo un viaje en tiempo y espacio. el era una maquina de tele transportación.

viejo, hombre, marinero, sabio, poeta, amigo, confidente, eso fue el en un verano para mi.

Ahora lo trato de buscar y no consigo encontrarlo. De el solo me queda un

poco de sogá con la que ataba su barco. todos me dijeron que no buscara, que era poco confiable, que no era bueno. Pero yo logre ver solo lo bueno, lo malo lo deje escondido. Yo no quería todo de él, solo una parte.

Cada herida en su cuerpo tenía una historia perfectamente narrada, con citas, ejemplos y detalles. Nunca cuestione su veracidad, pues era todo parte de su fantástico mundo en donde me estaba dejando viajar.

Fueron las vacaciones mas reales.

52

ROPE IN THE PALM OF THEIR HAND³¹

Just because the image of the ship, the ship's image is upside down, doesn't mean it's sinking. Everyday "F" sees the thing in the room. There's exactly the right amount. Everything gets moved around, like dust. And whatever is too heavy, or spoiled, or simply not loved, is thrown overboard. Either floating amidst bubbles of fibers, chemicals, universal secretions at the surface, or sinking its way down deeper, darker, bluer, colder, Love is going to find you again. It is an exercise to hold the rope at the borderline of tension – neither is it taut nor are you lifting it. When they open their hand another bird is revealed. A bird has been waiting there, gently protected in the palm of their hand, almost smothered. I can't remember your name.

Walk around to look from the other side, sings Judy Garland, with her breasts pressed up against my driver side window. She smiles like the sun and she smells like books. That's because you are reading. OK, pull a little bit on the rope, just to see what happens. Your mast is a thread in the heart. The extra money you spent on finely woven, elastically resilient Donna Karan fish net stockings in classic black. He explained to me when he was a girl in school all her boyfriends wore lipstick and you were suckered into chasing them down the train tracks drunken eventually one night wearing heels. But they are older now and would never dream of running in high heels again, beyond the purview of Charlie Chaplin.

Up on deck, everyone takes a turn walking past you and does not make eye contact and you can smell them because the ocean wind is almost warm.

Everyone takes a turn with the rope in the palm of their hand. Some will pull down immediately, anticipating the tug of the wind-blown masts. Some will turn to face the moon and the sun and somehow manage to get their bodies completely bound up in it. Some build their muscles supporting the clouds on their stony shoulders, holding the rope in the palm of their hand as if it is a bird. Actually you hold it as if it is a flacid cock. You touch it to your own cock or place it between your breasts. Jim wants to know if you are a man or a woman. I met Jim on the bus maybe many years ago.

What do I want to tell you about him? He was DEFINITELY NOT A THREAT. :only interested in G.E. What' s G.E.?

General Information. What's the sound of that water? Who fought in the war and what was their duty? What year was the palm tree planted at 123 Acacia Drive? That must be saturated in pastel color in Californian sunny sunny suburb in the 1960s or 1980s. What date and what time did the King learn to spell "cake" ? Why did the time change? Did you change the time on the clock? Is that the right time? We run a tight ship but there really is no time, the way I think you think or how a strawberry tastes when you put it in your mouth.



ENDNOTES

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- ¹ Postcard of an untitled illustration by Florian Weiss
- ² Postcard of an untitled illustration by Florian Weiss
- ³ Reading: “Rob’ s Word Shop” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ⁴ Listening: “For Ann Rising” by James Tenney
- ⁵ Listening: “For Ann Rising” by James Tenney
- ⁶ Listening: “For Ann Rising” by James Tenney
- ⁷ Reading: “Rob’ s Word Shop” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ⁸ Listening: the first 15 minutes of *Buy* by James Chance
- ⁹ Listening: the first 15 minutes of *Buy* by James Chance
- ¹⁰ Listening: the first 15 minutes of *Buy* by James Chance
- ¹¹ Listening: live piano improvisation #2 by Pablo Tameo
- ¹² Listening: live piano improvisation #2 by Pablo Tameo
- ¹³ Listening: live piano improvisation #2 by Pablo Tameo
- ¹⁴ Painting of unknown name by Anabella Papa
- ¹⁵ Listening: live piano improvisation #2 by Pablo Tameo
- ¹⁶ Postcard of a photograph called “Nantes” by Caroline Gabard
- ¹⁷ Listening: “Nightvision” (Longer Version – 33:43) by Daft Punk, on repeat
- ¹⁸ Listening: “Nightvision” (Longer Version – 33:43) by Daft Punk, on repeat
- ¹⁹ Reading: “Have you studied the soft toes of Geckos?” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ²⁰ Reading: “Have you studied the soft toes of Geckos?” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ²¹ Reading: “Have you studied the soft toes of Geckos?” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ²² Watching: Pizza Suicide TV Live (live internet stream)
- ²³ Watercolor image called “Atienda el teléfono con voz animada” in *Haberlo sabido antes* by Sábat
- ²⁴ Listening: live piano improvisation #1 by Pablo Tameo
- ²⁵ Listening: live piano improvisation #1 by Pablo Tameo
- ²⁶ Listening: live piano improvisation #1 by Pablo Tameo
- ²⁷ Listening: live piano improvisation #1 by Pablo Tameo
- ²⁸ Reading: “Against Ordinary Language: The Language of the Body” by Kathy Acker
- ²⁹ Reading: “bill bissett’s Rush: what fuckan theory; a study uv language” in *Seen of the Crime: Essays on Conceptual Writing* by Derek Beaulieu
- ³⁰ Postcard of an untitled illustration by Florian Weiss
- ³¹ Postcard of an untitled illustration by Florian Weiss